Indians are complimented for being 'good at learning', Indian factory workers and vocational workers are thought to be better than Chinese counterparts, and the international success of Indian managers both puzzles and inspires.[71] Even Indian social welfare policies get a positive review. Ren, a Chinese journalist, returns from a trip to India and reports on the ease of buying railway tickets and subsidized medical care for migrants.[72]

Chinese and Indian Media Representations

Vishwanath, Seth, and Patil provide a set of vignettes and snapshots of Chinese attitudes towards India. Is there more systematic data? As it turns out, there is, in the form of some interesting studies of Chinese media representations of India and Indians and also some Indian views of China.

Chinese racism

In 2011, Simon Shen, a professor at the Hong Kong Education Institute, published a fascinating study of Chinese online comments on India and Indians.[73] He tabulated opinions posted in various chat forums and concluded that Chinese netizens have a fairly 'monolithic' view of India. In the case of Japan and the US, perceptions vary a fair bit, but when it comes to India there are two dominant, negative perceptions across liberals and nationalists: 'India as the "yellow sick man" and its depiction as a trouble-maker for Beijing'.[74]

Shen's research shows that racial ignorance and stereotypes run deep. For some Chinese, Indians are the same racial type as Africans because of their skin colour. Both are placed at the lowest rung of the racial rankings. Among the racist stereotypes is that Indians are dirty and smell of 'curry'. In some of the commentary, because Indians wash themselves with the left hand after defecating, their hands are described as disgusting. Words associated with India include 'the rubbish nation' and 'dirty, messy and bad'. The disdain extends to India's economy. Shen notes that virtually all